

Boswell Consulting Group

Independent Artist Administration System™

The Complete Release, Royalty, Metadata, and Registration System for Independent Recording Artists

Version 1.0

Educational Use Only

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Disclaimer

Boswell Consulting Group provides this product for educational and administrative guidance only. It is not legal, tax, accounting, financial, investment, or business-formation advice. Users should consult qualified legal, tax, accounting, or financial professionals for advice about their specific situation. Official portal workflows, fees, eligibility rules, and data fields may change; verify current requirements directly with the official portal before submitting registrations, claims, applications, or tax information.

Start Here

This product is built only for independent recording artists. It does not combine artist and producer workflows. Use it one release, song, beat, or placement at a time.

1. Choose one item to organize first.
2. Open the main tracker.
3. Fill the identity/profile tab.
4. Enter the song, release, beat, or placement.
5. Complete the step-by-step modules in order.
6. Save confirmations and proof as you go.
7. Run the quarterly audit.

Seven-Day Setup

Day	Action
Day 1	Set up the profile tab, admin folder, account tracker, and one release or placement to organize first.
Day 2	Confirm ownership, split, role, deal, or release status. Mark unresolved items clearly.
Day 3	Build clean metadata and naming records.
Day 4	Check official registration or portal accounts that apply to this product.
Day 5	Prepare release, delivery, or placement files and save proof.
Day 6	Enter registration, claim, delivery, or deal status into the tracker.
Day 7	Run the final status check and schedule the next quarterly audit.

Module 1: Release Admin Map for Independent Artists

Do This Step by Step

1. Pick one song, not the whole catalog.
2. Separate the sound recording from the composition.
3. Write down artist, writers, producers, featured artists, master owner, publisher/self-administered status, and distributor.
4. Mark the royalty lanes: distributor, PRO, The MLC, SoundExchange, copyright decision, and direct licensing.
5. Enter every missing item into the Missing Information Log.

Common Mistakes

- Thinking distributor upload handles everything.
- Using different names across portals.
- Skipping SoundExchange because the song is already on streaming platforms.

Quick Reference

Lane	Artist Action
Distributor	Upload release and save UPC/ISRC/store links.
PRO	Join ASCAP or BMI, then register compositions.
The MLC	Register or claim compositions for eligible U.S. digital mechanical royalties.
SoundExchange	Register or claim recordings as featured artist and/or rights owner.
Copyright	Decide whether to register composition, sound recording, or both using Copyright Office guidance.

Done Standard

- The tracker has a clear status.
- Proof or confirmation is saved in the right folder.
- Any unresolved issue has a next action and due date.
- Official portal requirements were checked before submission when applicable.

Module 2: Artist Identity and Release Foundation

Do This Step by Step

1. Choose exact artist name spelling.
2. Check major platforms and social handles for confusing conflicts.
3. Create one music admin email and secure account recovery plan.
4. Set up folder structure for songs, releases, registrations, and statements.
5. Use IRS.gov only for EIN information if needed and verify tax questions with a qualified professional.

Common Mistakes

- Changing artist spelling after release.
- Using personal inboxes that collaborators can access.
- Forming an LLC without understanding state and tax responsibilities.

Quick Reference

Foundation Item	Save This
Artist name	Official spelling and platform URLs.
Admin email	Recovery email and 2FA method.
Business/tax records	EIN confirmation if applicable, saved securely.
Folders	Song folder, release folder, registration folder, statement folder.

Done Standard

- The tracker has a clear status.
- Proof or confirmation is saved in the right folder.
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Module 3: Artist Split and Ownership Process

Do This Step by Step

1. List every person involved in the song and recording.
2. Separate writer shares from master ownership.
3. Document featured artist terms separately from writer terms.
4. Confirm producer credit and any producer participation, but do not use producer language as a substitute for ownership terms.
5. Do not release until unresolved splits are marked and addressed.

Common Mistakes

- Letting verbal split conversations replace written records.
- Making percentages total 99% or 101%.
- Treating featured artist credit as automatic publishing ownership.

Quick Reference

Ownership Category	Artist Question
Writer share	Who wrote the composition and what percentage?
Master owner	Who owns the recording?
Featured artist	What credit and payment terms apply?
Producer participation	Is this fee-only, points, publishing, master share, or other?

Done Standard

- The tracker has a clear status.
- Proof or confirmation is saved in the right folder.
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Module 4: Artist Copyright Decision

Do This Step by Step

1. Decide whether the work is composition, sound recording, or both.
2. Check whether ownership of composition and recording is exactly the same.
3. Prepare title, authors, claimant, completion year, publication status, and deposit file.
4. Use copyright.gov and verify the current eCO/GRAM workflow before filing.
5. Save case number, payment receipt, and certificate when issued.

Common Mistakes

- Assuming upload equals copyright registration.
- Registering the wrong work type.
- Losing the case number.

Quick Reference

Decision	Plain-English Rule
Composition	The song itself: melody, lyrics, musical work.
Sound recording	The specific master recording.
Both	Verify current Copyright Office rules before trying to combine coverage.

Done Standard

- The tracker has a clear status.
- Proof or confirmation is saved in the right folder.
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Module 5: ASCAP/BMI and Song Registration

Do This Step by Step

1. Choose one songwriter PRO path after checking official ASCAP and BMI pages.
2. Create songwriter account and publisher account only if appropriate under current official rules.
3. Register each composition after membership is active.
4. Add all writers, shares, alternate titles, and publisher data if applicable.
5. Save work ID, confirmation, status, and follow-up date.

Common Mistakes

- Joining a PRO but not registering songs.
- Joining both ASCAP and BMI as the same writer.
- Inventing publisher names.

Quick Reference

Step	What To Save
Join	Member number and IPI/CAE when available.
Register work	Work ID, title, shares, writer names.
Verify	Status and Songview/repertory check if applicable.

Done Standard

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Module 6: MLC and SoundExchange for Artists

Do This Step by Step

1. Use The MLC for eligible U.S. digital mechanical royalties tied to the composition.
2. Use SoundExchange for statutory digital performance royalties tied to the recording.
3. Prepare ISRCs, titles, writer data, artist names, release titles, and ownership roles.
4. Claim or register what belongs to you and mark unclear items Verify.
5. Check unmatched, unclaimed, missing, or pending items quarterly.

Common Mistakes

- Thinking MLC and SoundExchange do the same thing.
- Leaving ISRCs blank after distributor approval.
- Claiming rights owner status without confirming master ownership.

Quick Reference

Organization	Artist Use
The MLC	Composition-side eligible U.S. digital mechanicals.
SoundExchange	Recording-side statutory digital performances.
Distributor	Store/streaming delivery revenue from the master.

Done Standard

- The tracker has a clear status.
- Proof or confirmation is saved in the right folder.
- Any unresolved issue has a next action and due date.
- Official portal requirements were checked before submission when applicable.

Module 7: Distributor Upload and Metadata

Do This Step by Step

1. Choose the distributor before finalizing release date.
2. Prepare final WAV, artwork, track title, version, explicit status, artists, writers, producers, label, publisher, and release date.
3. Confirm whether the distributor assigns or accepts ISRCs and UPCs.
4. Upload at least 30 days early when possible.
5. After approval, copy UPC, ISRCs, and store links into the tracker.

Common Mistakes

- Putting featured artists in the title instead of the feature field when the distributor provides one.
- Uploading artwork that conflicts with metadata.
- Changing ISRCs unnecessarily.

Quick Reference

Metadata Field	Clean Example
Track title	Midnight Invoice
Version	Clean Version
Primary artist	Avery Stone
Featured artist	Lena Fox
ISRC	Use distributor-assigned or valid existing code.

Done Standard

- The tracker has a clear status.
- Proof or confirmation is saved in the right folder.
- Any unresolved issue has a next action and due date.
- Official portal requirements were checked before submission when applicable.

Module 8: Artist Release Calendar and Quarterly Audit

Do This Step by Step

1. 30 days before release, finish splits, metadata, audio, artwork, and upload plan.
2. 14 days before release, submit distributor upload.
3. 7 days before release, verify identifiers and registrations.
4. Release day, check live links and artist profile mapping.
5. Each quarter, check distributor, PRO, MLC, and SoundExchange status against the Song Catalog.

Common Mistakes

- Never checking whether the song mapped to the right artist profile.
- Only reviewing distributor money.
- Letting pending issues sit without due dates.

Quick Reference

Timing	Artist Check
30 days before	Splits and metadata final.
Release day	Links and profile mapping correct.
30 days after	Registrations and claims checked.
Quarterly	Statements and missing items reviewed.

Done Standard

- The tracker has a clear status.
- Proof or confirmation is saved in the right folder.
- Any unresolved issue has a next action and due date.
- Official portal requirements were checked before submission when applicable.

Official Sources

Source	URL
U.S. Copyright Office registration FAQ	https://www.copyright.gov/help/faq/faq-register.html
U.S. Copyright Office PA/SR registration	https://www.copyright.gov/register/pa-sr.html
U.S. Copyright Office GRAM	https://www.copyright.gov/gram/
ASCAP official site	https://www.ascap.com/
ASCAP join	https://www.ascap.com/join
ASCAP repertory/Songview	https://www.ascap.com/repertory
BMI official site	https://www.bmi.com/
BMI join	https://www.bmi.com/join
BMI repertory/Songview	https://repertoire.bmi.com/main/search
The MLC official site	https://www.themlc.com/
The MLC FAQ	https://www.themlc.com/faqs/categories/mlc
The MLC historical unmatched royalties	https://www.themlc.com/historical-unmatched-royalties
SoundExchange registration	https://register.soundexchange.com/
SoundExchange register page	https://www.soundexchange.com/register/
SoundExchange who we are	https://www.soundexchange.com/who-we-are/
DistroKid Help Center	https://support.distrokid.com/
DistroKid ISRC/UPC help	https://support.distrokid.com/hc/en-us/articles/360013648993
TuneCore Help Center	https://support.tunecore.com/
TuneCore UPCs and ISRCs	https://support.tunecore.com/hc/en-in/articles/115006499567-TuneCore-UPCs-and-ISRCs

Source	URL
CD Baby Help Center	https://support.cdbaby.com/
CD Baby ISRC explanation	https://support.cdbaby.com/hc/en-us/articles/360019038511-Understanding-ISRCs
IRS EIN information	https://www.irs.gov/businesses/small-businesses-self-employed/apply-for-an-employer-identification-number-ein-online

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